BRIGHT C. SIKAZWE

AI & Agentic Transformation Leader | Human–Agent Operating Models · Process Redesign · Investable AI Programmes

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CERTIFIED: **AWS Certified AI Business Strategist** · Google Cloud Professional Data Engineer · Microsoft Azure Data Engineer Associate · Fabric Analytics Engineer · Anthropic Claude API, MCP & Agent Skills · Google Cloud AI Agents & Responsible AI · McKinsey Product Academy

PROFILE

Data, AI and transformation leader with seventeen years turning emerging technology into operating change — eleven at MultiChoice Group (a Canal+ company), rising through four roles to Acting Principal Engineer & Lead, Data Platforms & Engineering, for a ~20M-subscriber business across 46 African markets, plus founder of brytesika-AI, an applied-AI practice with ~10 production systems across several industries. My work sits where this role sits: I start from the end-to-end process and the decisions inside it, not the model. I decide which decisions stay human, which become machine-assisted and which can run autonomously; redesign the workflow around that split; prove value with a lighthouse; then build the governance, data and platform needed to scale it. I move between a COO conversation about where work breaks and a CTO conversation about agent orchestration, observability and control — and I have built agents in production, so my advice is grounded in what actually works. AWS Certified AI Business Strategist; Master of Management (Digital Business, Wits); PhD candidate (University of Johannesburg) in ethical and responsible AI for strategic decision-making.

FIT TO THE ROLE

- **Process redesign, not task automation —** re-cut 140,798 customer calls by the business decision that failed upstream, so AI targets the broken process instead of answering the same call faster.
- **Human / machine / autonomous decision rights —** cheap models handle routine cases, stronger models handle edge cases, and people own low-confidence and high-risk calls; every escalation is logged.
- **Agent orchestration & lifecycle —** five-agent production pipeline with routing, evaluation, human hand-off and audit trail; authored the governance standard my AI work runs on.
- **Opportunity portfolios —** AI interventions ranked by value, feasibility, data readiness, risk, strategic fit and time to value.
- **Lighthouse to scale —** proved value on Microsoft Fabric, then moved to a live, consumption-priced AWS service; investment gated on evidence.
- **Strategy to architecture —** connects operating model to platform, data, security, privacy (POPIA masking before any model call) and cost.
- **Vendor challenge —** evaluated Fabric, AWS Bedrock, Google Gemini and Claude on value, cost and lock-in; built MOSAIC, a build-buy-integrate decision tool.
- **Practice building —** founded and run an AI practice: shape propositions, write bids and proposals, build reusable IP; former lecturer; mentor engineers and analysts.

SELECTED TRANSFORMATION WORK

Technical Calls Intelligence — from an agent experiment to an enterprise operating capability (MultiChoice, live on AWS)

- **Executive question:** Operations could count 140,798 technical calls but not explain them: which business decision failed, who owned it, and which contacts were preventable.
- **Redesign:** Every call mapped to an enterprise outcome, one of 12 customer value streams, the failed upstream decision, an accountable owner and a preventive intervention — turning a call-handling problem into a process-redesign portfolio across billing, entitlements, reconnections and field service.
- **Human–agent model:** Tiered decisioning: routine calls classified automatically, uncertain cases escalated to stronger models, low-confidence and sensitive cases routed to people; quality-judge checks and full audit trail.
- **Investment case & scale:** Portfolio ranked by value, feasibility, data readiness, risk and time to value with agreed KPIs (avoidable demand, digital deflection, automation potential, repeat contact, revenue and retention risk). Proved on Fabric; now live on serverless AWS with Bedrock batch inference, so cost tracks usage.

Agentic incident triage in production — MultiChoice

- **Delivered:** A five-agent pipeline with human escalation, replacing manual first-line triage; plus AI classification of support conversations by decoder error code, separating network faults from billing blockers so each reaches the right team.
- **Operating model:** Defined agent roles, hand-offs, confidence thresholds and who owns each decision — the template for later agent work.

Enterprise transformation with C-suite visibility — CANAL+ and MultiChoice

- **Fleet upgrade (FSU/CCA):** Data lead on a 14-million-device, 46-country programme; daily executive view; root-cause analysis isolated a fault on ~1.6M devices and guided a fix for ~1.4M; security-integrity exposure cut from 52% to under 1%.
- **Cross-border standard:** Resolved an 8× gap with the CANAL+ Paris team on how viewers are counted; the method became a joint standard and produced 298,772 campaign-ready customers for marketing automation.

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

MultiChoice Group (a Canal+ company) | Johannesburg *Jan 2014 – Present*

Acting Principal Engineer & Lead, Data Platforms & Engineering *2025 – Present*

- Lead data and AI for a ~20M-subscriber, 46-market business; shape AI programmes from executive question to production; formal team lead; advise senior VP leadership on priorities and investment.

Senior Engineer: Infield Insights (Engineering Analytical) *2019 – 2025*

- Built device telemetry and AI analytics; delivered the five-agent triage pipeline and the cross-border segmentation adopted with CANAL+.

Senior Analytics Lead, Group Analytics (2015–2019) · Senior Data Analyst (2014–2015) *2014 – 2019*

- Group-wide subscriber, sales and marketing analytics; KPI and process design for commercial teams.

brytesika-AI (applied-AI practice) | Founder & Principal *2025 – Present*

- ~10 production AI systems across multiple verticals, including ChickenIQ (live poultry-health app) and MOSAIC (build-buy-integrate decision tool); originate and write proposals and public-sector bids; open-source portfolio of 18+ repositories.

Earlier career *2009 – 2014*

- UTi Worldwide — BI Operations Lead (2012–2014) • Standard Bank Group — BI Consultant (2011–2012) • Monash University — Junior Lecturer, computing and AI (2009–2010).

FORMAL EDUCATION

- PhD candidate — University of Johannesburg. Research: ethical and responsible AI for strategic decision-making.
- Master of Management (MMgt), Digital Business — Wits Business School.
- BSc Honours, Computing — Monash • BSc Computer Science — Copperbelt University.

PROFESSIONAL CERTIFICATIONS

- **AI strategy:** AWS Certified AI Business Strategist (AIB-C01), October 2026 — AI use-case selection, investment cases, responsible-AI governance, and scaling from pilot to production.
- **Agentic AI:** Anthropic — Claude API, Model Context Protocol, Agent Skills, AI Fluency; Google Cloud AI-agent series; Google Responsible AI series; Oracle Generative AI Professional.
- **Cloud, data & product:** Google Cloud Professional Data Engineer (2026); Microsoft Azure Data Engineer Associate; Fabric Analytics Engineer; Power BI Data Analyst; McKinsey Product Academy.
- **In progress:** Google Cloud Professional Cloud Architect; AWS Data Engineer Associate; AWS Generative AI Developer Professional.

METHODS & TOOLKIT

- Value-stream and decision mapping; human-agent decision-rights design; opportunity scoring and portfolio prioritisation; investment cases, KPIs and stage gates; agent orchestration, evaluation and observability; responsible-AI controls; executive workshops and storytelling. Platforms: AWS (Bedrock, Step Functions, Glue), Microsoft Fabric, Google BigQuery and Vertex AI, Databricks, Claude and Gemini.